

What did real waiver bids tell us?

A replay of production strategies plus analysis-only Middle VoRP and corrected PR #13 curves against 355 anonymized bids from SeaMex 2026. Useful signal, but not enough stable evidence to crown a default.

Evidence window

Reconstructed decision weeks W2 and W3 and W4

Data through

2026-09-30T07:50:30.120Z

Scope

One 32-team league · \$500 FAAB

Five-bullet answer

- Newest supported week W4 top-three winning multipliers (arithmetic/geometric/median; coverage): Max VoRP a/g/m 2.74/2.73/2.71× (coverage 3/3); Current-team VoRP a/g/m 3.02/2.98/2.75× (coverage 3/3); Corrected Safe a/g/m 2.07/2.00/1.89× (coverage 3/3); Corrected Weeks as Starter a/g/m 2.21/2.17/2.05× (coverage 3/3). Pooled season-to-date top-three: Max VoRP a/g/m 2.81/2.67/2.71× (coverage 9/9); Current-team VoRP a/g/m 3.13/3.00/2.75× (coverage 9/9); Corrected Safe a/g/m 2.10/1.96/1.89× (coverage 9/9); Corrected Weeks as Starter a/g/m 2.33/2.15/2.05× (coverage 9/9).
- Newest supported week W4 top-three serious-market multipliers (arithmetic/geometric/median; coverage): Max VoRP a/g/m 1.45/1.44/1.45× (coverage 3/3); Current-team VoRP a/g/m 1.61/1.57/1.47× (coverage 3/3); Corrected Safe a/g/m 1.11/1.05/1.01× (coverage 3/3); Corrected Weeks as Starter a/g/m 1.18/1.14/1.10× (coverage 3/3). Pooled season-to-date top-three: Max VoRP a/g/m 1.21/1.16/1.34× (coverage 9/9); Current-team VoRP a/g/m 1.34/1.30/1.36× (coverage 9/9); Corrected Safe a/g/m 0.90/0.85/0.71× (coverage 9/9); Corrected Weeks as Starter a/g/m 0.99/0.93/0.82× (coverage 9/9).
- Serious-market raw identity fit — W4: Max VoRP R² 0.68, MAE 17.2, p 0.75, n=10; Current-team VoRP R² 0.52, MAE 19.6, p 0.72, n=10; Corrected Safe R² 0.60, MAE 25.3, p 0.78, n=10; Corrected Weeks as Starter R² 0.72, MAE 16.3, p 0.77, n=10. Cumulative: Max VoRP R² 0.67, MAE 14.0, p 0.79, n=31; Current-team VoRP R² 0.59, MAE 13.8, p 0.78, n=31; Corrected Safe R² 0.30, MAE 22.9, p 0.83, n=31; Corrected Weeks as Starter R² 0.56, MAE 17.3, p 0.80, n=30. R² is an unfitted prediction score, not fitted-regression R².
- Closest current strategy: W4 Corrected Weeks as Starter (MAE 16.3). Versus W3, Corrected Weeks as Starter's MAE changed -3.8; leadership changed Current-team VoRP → Corrected Weeks as Starter. Cumulative leader: Current-team VoRP (MAE 13.8).
- Material trend W3→W4: serious-market top-three arithmetic multipliers rose for 4/4 comparable methods and fell for 0/4 (Δ range +0.47× to +0.67×). Recommendation: do not change any formula from this small reconstructed sample; treat shape and market scale separately. Provenance caveat: deterministic anonymized fixture from read-only Supabase tables projection_snapshot_runs and projection_snapshot_values and Sleeper GET /v1/league/[private], /v1/players/nfl, and /v1/league/[private]/transactions/{week}; same-week snapshots are reconstructed, not proof of the pre-waiver forecast.

Scope guardrail

W2, W3, W4 have like-for-like same-week reconstructed snapshots; earlier-week fallbacks are never backfilled. Aggressive is omitted here because it is derived from Safe.

CLOSEST MEDIAN MARKET

Current-team VoRP

Lowest MAE across owner-directed player/week clusters; competing claims stay within the canonical winner's processing batch.

STRATEGY × SCALE

Separate them

Intrinsic formulas describe target shape; observed/intrinsic multipliers estimate weekly market scale.

PRODUCT DECISION

Hold

3 reconstructed weeks do not support manager-style claims or a production default change.

Middle VORP stays analysis-only.

One shared horizon: $\text{targetTeams} = \max(4, \text{ceil}(\text{teamsRemaining} / 2))$. At the latest reproducible W4 state, 26 teams map to 13. It never maximizes a different stage per player.

Recommendation: retain analysis-only

- Conceptually cleaner than per-player Max VORP stage selection.
- Only W2, W3, W4 are evaluable and all 3 projection snapshots are reconstructed.
- W5+ exact pre-waiver captures must confirm held-out error, bias, rank quality, and 33%/50%/67% stability before any default review.

Privacy-safe current input

W4, 1151 stored rows / 452 supported QB/RB/WR/TE players, hash 9463b40e63b71c00...; aliases only, no league/manager identity or raw payload.

Current-state dollar distributions

Full supported QB/RB/WR/TE projection population; positive counts make each method's support explicit.

METHOD	N	POSITIVE	MEAN	MEDIAN	P75	MAX	TOTAL
Max VORP	452	176	13.7	0.0	18.0	\$184	\$6176
Middle VORP	452	86	7.3	0.0	0.0	\$114	\$3317
Current-team VoRP	452	176	12.2	0.0	18.0	\$102	\$5535
Corrected Safe	452	178	20.9	0.0	39.0	\$125	\$9459
Corrected Weeks as Starter	452	169	14.8	0.0	15.0	\$125	\$6705

Positional positive-price cutoffs Deepest positive rank by method and position.			
METHOD	POSITION	POSITIVE	DEEPEST RANK
Max VORP	QB	25	25
Max VORP	RB	51	51
Max VORP	WR	71	71
Max VORP	TE	29	29
Middle VORP	QB	12	12
Middle VORP	RB	25	25
Middle VORP	WR	37	37
Middle VORP	TE	12	12
Current-team VoRP	QB	25	25
Current-team VoRP	RB	51	51
Current-team VoRP	WR	71	71
Current-team VoRP	TE	29	29
Corrected Safe	QB	25	25
Corrected Safe	RB	51	51
Corrected Safe	WR	73	73
Corrected Safe	TE	29	29
Corrected Weeks as Starter	QB	24	24
Corrected Weeks as Starter	RB	48	48
Corrected Weeks as Starter	WR	69	69
Corrected Weeks as Starter	TE	28	28

Top-12 ordering.
Max: P1118 (RB1, \$184), P1131 (WR1, \$165), P1139 (RB2, \$162), P1130 (WR2, \$160), P1148 (WR3, \$150), P0998 (TE1, \$140), P0702 (QB1, \$117), P0642 (RB3, \$112), P0915 (WR4, \$102), P0144 (TE2, \$100), P0852 (RB4, \$89), P0613 (RB5, \$85)
Middle: P1118 (RB1, \$114), P1139 (RB2, \$107), P1131 (WR1, \$104), P1130 (WR2, \$102), P1148 (WR3, \$100), P0642 (RB3, \$92), P0852 (RB4, \$85), P0915 (WR4, \$85), P0613 (RB5, \$83), P1013 (RB6, \$78), P1007 (WR5, \$77), P0702 (QB1, \$74)
Current: P1118 (RB1, \$102), P1139 (RB2, \$98), P1131 (WR1, \$92), P1130 (WR2, \$91), P1148 (WR3, \$89), P0642 (RB3, \$88), P0852 (RB4, \$84), P0613 (RB5, \$83), P0915 (WR4, \$80), P1013 (RB6, \$79), P1119 (RB7, \$77), P1005 (RB8, \$75)

Middle VORP top 12 and exact prices

Max-selected stage explains the per-player maximization contrast.

ALIAS (POSITION RANK)	MIDDLE	MAX	MAX STAGE	CURRENT	CORRECTED SAFE	CORRECTED WEEKS
P1118 (RB1)	\$114	\$184	4 teams	\$102	\$125	\$125
P1139 (RB2)	\$107	\$162	4 teams	\$98	\$108	\$108
P1131 (WR1)	\$104	\$165	4 teams	\$92	\$125	\$125
P1130 (WR2)	\$102	\$160	4 teams	\$91	\$108	\$108
P1148 (WR3)	\$100	\$150	4 teams	\$89	\$107	\$107
P0642 (RB3)	\$92	\$112	4 teams	\$88	\$106	\$106
P0852 (RB4)	\$85	\$89	4 teams	\$84	\$104	\$104
P0915 (WR4)	\$85	\$102	4 teams	\$80	\$105	\$105
P0613 (RB5)	\$83	\$85	17 teams	\$83	\$101	\$101
P1013 (RB6)	\$78	\$81	23 teams	\$79	\$99	\$91
P1007 (WR5)	\$77	\$83	11 teams	\$75	\$104	\$104
P0702 (QB1)	\$74	\$117	6 teams	\$73	\$94	\$94

Concrete divergence examples

Largest dollar gaps among players with positive Middle VORP.

ALIAS	MIDDLE	MAX	MAX-SELECTED STAGE	CURRENT
P0998 (TE1)	\$69	\$140	4 teams	\$63
P1118 (RB1)	\$114	\$184	4 teams	\$102
P1131 (WR1)	\$104	\$165	4 teams	\$92
P1130 (WR2)	\$102	\$160	4 teams	\$91
P1139 (RB2)	\$107	\$162	4 teams	\$98
P1148 (WR3)	\$100	\$150	4 teams	\$89
P0144 (TE2)	\$57	\$100	5 teams	\$55
P0702 (QB1)	\$74	\$117	6 teams	\$73

Rank correlations	Common-horizon sensitivity			
PAIR	Floor/ceil sensitivity stays explicit; unit tests cover the odd 27→14 versus 13 boundary.			
Middle vs Max VORP	HORIZON	TEAMS	POSITIVE	MEAN
Middle vs Current-team VoRP	67%	18	121	\$8.9
Middle vs Corrected Safe	50% ceil	13	86	\$7.3
Middle vs Corrected Weeks as Starter	50% floor	13	86	\$7.3
Middle vs 67% horizon	33%	9	59	\$5.5
Middle vs 33% horizon				

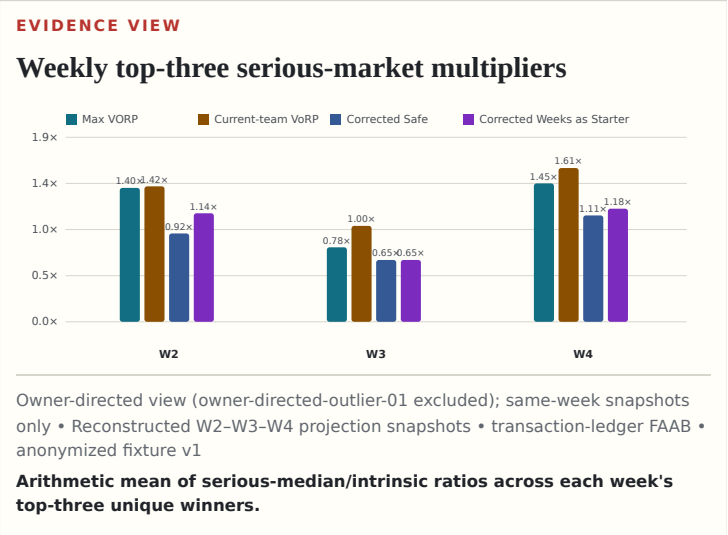
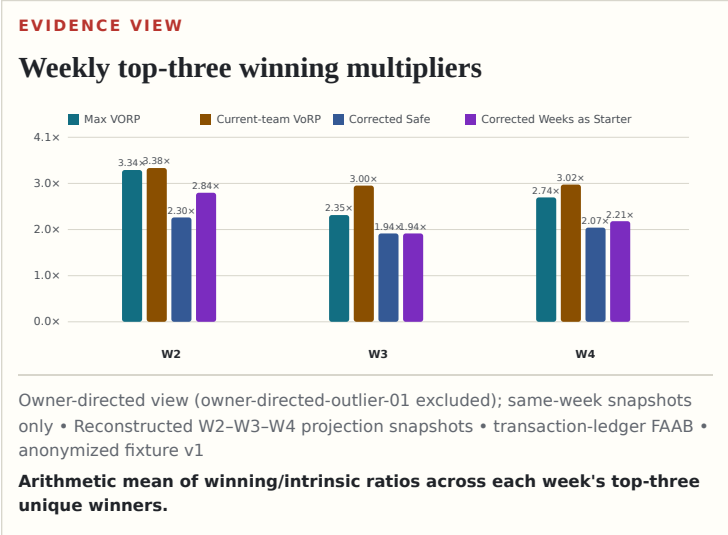
Historical common-horizon sensitivity				
Canonical winning bids, owner-directed exclusion applied; odd-team observations keep floor versus ceil differences visible.				
HORIZON	N	MAE	BIAS	P
67%	20	74.2	-72.3	0.823
50% ceil	14	100.4	-99.9	0.802
50% floor	14	100.4	-99.9	0.802
33%	12	113.8	-113.8	0.779

Shape is not scale.

Top-three canonical winners and serious market medians use observed bid ÷ intrinsic same-week suggestion. Arithmetic mean is primary; geometric mean, median, and coverage expose ratio skew and zero denominators.

Important metric label

Every value labeled **raw prediction R²*** keeps strategy dollar predictions fixed on the identity line. It is not the goodness-of-fit R² from a regression trained on these bids. Negative values are valid and mean the fixed predictions lose to the observed-mean baseline—not that correlation is negative.



Exact weekly top-three multipliers

Observed/intrinsic; arithmetic mean is primary, with geometric mean, median, and zero-denominator coverage.

WEEK	OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	COVERAGE	ARITHMETIC MEAN	GEOMETRIC MEAN	MEDIAN
W2	Winning bid	Max VORP	3/3	3.34×	3.21×	2.73×
W2	Winning bid	Current-team VoRP	3/3	3.38×	3.24×	2.78×
W2	Winning bid	Corrected Safe	3/3	2.30×	2.08×	2.01×
W2	Winning bid	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	2.84×	2.54×	2.51×
W2	Serious-market median	Max VORP	3/3	1.40×	1.40×	1.42×
W2	Serious-market median	Current-team VoRP	3/3	1.42×	1.42×	1.44×
W2	Serious-market median	Corrected Safe	3/3	0.92×	0.91×	0.99×
W2	Serious-market median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	1.14×	1.11×	1.23×
W3	Winning bid	Max VORP	3/3	2.35×	2.17×	2.23×
W3	Winning bid	Current-team VoRP	3/3	3.00×	2.79×	2.43×
W3	Winning bid	Corrected Safe	3/3	1.94×	1.81×	1.76×
W3	Winning bid	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	1.94×	1.81×	1.76×
W3	Serious-market median	Max VORP	3/3	0.78×	0.78×	0.79×
W3	Serious-market median	Current-team VoRP	3/3	1.00×	1.00×	1.03×
W3	Serious-market median	Corrected Safe	3/3	0.65×	0.65×	0.63×
W3	Serious-market median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	0.65×	0.65×	0.63×
W4	Winning bid	Max VORP	3/3	2.74×	2.73×	2.71×
W4	Winning bid	Current-team VoRP	3/3	3.02×	2.98×	2.75×
W4	Winning bid	Corrected Safe	3/3	2.07×	2.00×	1.89×
W4	Winning bid	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	2.21×	2.17×	2.05×
W4	Serious-market median	Max VORP	3/3	1.45×	1.44×	1.45×
W4	Serious-market median	Current-team VoRP	3/3	1.61×	1.57×	1.47×
W4	Serious-market median	Corrected Safe	3/3	1.11×	1.05×	1.01×
W4	Serious-market median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	3/3	1.18×	1.14×	1.10×

Top-three winning-bid ratios (privacy-safe labels) Canonical winning bid ÷ intrinsic suggestion; exact FAAB equality is labeled censored.							
target	week	winning bid	faab-censored	max vorp	current-team vorp	corrected safe	corrected weeks as starter
W2 target 1	W2	\$285	no	4.75×	4.83×	3.65×	4.60×
W2 target 2	W2	\$153	no	2.73×	2.78×	2.01×	2.51×
W2 target 3	W2	\$99	no	2.54×	2.54×	1.22×	1.41×
W3 target 1	W3	\$231	no	3.50×	4.62×	2.92×	2.92×
W3 target 2	W3	\$187	no	2.23×	2.43×	1.76×	1.76×
W3 target 3	W3	\$103	no	1.32×	1.94×	1.14×	1.14×
W4 target 1	W4	\$300	no	2.94×	3.75×	2.86×	2.86×
W4 target 2	W4	\$187	no	2.71×	2.75×	1.89×	2.05×
W4 target 3	W4	\$128	no	2.56×	2.56×	1.47×	1.73×

Top-three serious-market ratios (privacy-safe labels) Serious median ÷ intrinsic suggestion; competitors are canonical legitimate failures with bid > \$5.							
target	week	serious median	censored obs.	max vorp	current-team vorp	corrected safe	corrected weeks as starter
W2 target 1	W2	\$85.0	0	1.42×	1.44×	1.09×	1.37×
W2 target 2	W2	\$75.0	0	1.34×	1.36×	0.99×	1.23×
W2 target 3	W2	\$56.5	0	1.45×	1.45×	0.70×	0.81×
W3 target 1	W3	\$56.0	0	0.85×	1.12×	0.71×	0.71×
W3 target 2	W3	\$66.5	0	0.79×	0.86×	0.63×	0.63×
W3 target 3	W3	\$54.5	0	0.70×	1.03×	0.61×	0.61×
W4 target 1	W4	\$171.0	0	1.68×	2.14×	1.63×	1.63×
W4 target 2	W4	\$100.0	0	1.45×	1.47×	1.01×	1.10×
W4 target 3	W4	\$61.0	0	1.22×	1.22×	0.70×	0.82×

Median-market fit: overall, by week, and all-bid sensitivity

★ lowest MAE within scope; bias = intrinsic – observed. Raw prediction R^{2*} uses fixed strategy dollars with no regression refit.

SCOPE	OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	N	MAE	MEDIAN AE	BIAS	RAW PREDICTION R ² *	SPEARMAN P
Overall	Canonical winner	Max VORP	36	40.0	17.0	-36.4	0.26	0.91
Overall	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	36	42.1	17.0	-38.5	0.17	0.90
Overall	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe ★	36	34.1	16.5	-18.9	0.41	0.91
Overall	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	34	38.0	18.0	-34.2	0.33	0.90
Overall	Serious median	Max VORP	31	14.0	8.0	-3.7	0.67	0.79
Overall	Serious median	Current-team VoRP ★	31	13.8	7.0	-6.1	0.59	0.78
Overall	Serious median	Corrected Safe	31	22.9	23.0	+15.7	0.30	0.83
Overall	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	30	17.3	12.5	+1.4	0.56	0.80
Overall	All-bid sensitivity	Max VORP	36	12.6	9.0	+3.5	0.74	0.86
Overall	All-bid sensitivity	Current-team VoRP ★	36	12.1	8.3	+1.4	0.68	0.86
Overall	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Safe	36	25.1	25.5	+21.1	0.24	0.87
Overall	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Weeks as Starter	34	15.4	12.0	+7.8	0.63	0.88
W2	Canonical winner	Max VORP	14	35.0	8.0	-29.3	0.21	0.85
W2	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	14	35.1	8.0	-29.5	0.20	0.85
W2	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe ★	14	32.1	15.0	-13.8	0.36	0.85
W2	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	13	34.9	10.0	-29.5	0.24	0.87
W2	Serious median	Max VORP ★	11	14.9	14.0	-3.7	0.52	0.81
W2	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	11	15.0	14.0	-4.0	0.52	0.81
W2	Serious median	Corrected Safe	11	18.7	12.0	+14.3	0.06	0.83
W2	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10	15.4	12.3	-0.5	0.47	0.80
W2	All-bid sensitivity	Max VORP	14	12.6	10.0	+2.9	0.65	0.81
W2	All-bid sensitivity	Current-team VoRP	14	12.7	10.0	+2.6	0.65	0.81
W2	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Safe	14	19.4	10.0	+18.4	0.08	0.80
W2	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Weeks as Starter ★	13	12.5	12.5	+4.7	0.63	0.84
W3	Canonical winner	Max VORP	11	37.5	21.0	-35.3	0.28	0.91
W3	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	11	41.8	21.0	-39.6	0.12	0.91
W3	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe ★	11	31.6	13.0	-18.5	0.44	0.91
W3	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	11	35.3	19.0	-30.5	0.41	0.87
W3	Serious median	Max VORP	10	9.9	8.0	+7.1	0.65	0.91
W3	Serious median	Current-team VoRP ★	10	6.6	6.0	+2.3	0.85	0.91
W3	Serious median	Corrected Safe	10	25.0	25.0	+24.8	-1.37	0.91

SCOPE	OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	N	MAE	MEDIAN AE	BIAS	RAW PREDICTION R ² *	SPEARMAN P
W3	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10	20.1	18.5	+12.5	-0.50	0.88
W3	All-bid sensitivity	Max VORP	11	11.4	8.5	+10.9	0.66	0.89
W3	All-bid sensitivity	Current-team VoRP ★	11	7.9	8.0	+6.5	0.83	0.89
W3	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Safe	11	27.6	26.0	+27.6	-1.04	0.89
W3	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Weeks as Starter	11	17.8	10.0	+15.6	-0.14	0.84
W4	Canonical winner	Max VORP	11	49.0	33.0	-46.6	0.25	0.90
W4	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	11	51.2	34.0	-48.8	0.13	0.89
W4	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe ★	11	39.1	19.0	-25.6	0.42	0.93
W4	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10	44.9	26.0	-44.3	0.32	0.88
W4	Serious median	Max VORP	10	17.2	6.5	-14.6	0.68	0.75
W4	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	10	19.6	6.5	-17.0	0.52	0.72
W4	Serious median	Corrected Safe	10	25.3	26.0	+8.1	0.60	0.78
W4	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter ★	10	16.3	9.0	-7.9	0.72	0.77
W4	All-bid sensitivity	Max VORP ★	11	13.6	9.0	-3.0	0.77	0.91
W4	All-bid sensitivity	Current-team VoRP	11	15.4	8.0	-5.2	0.64	0.90
W4	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Safe	11	30.0	27.0	+18.0	0.53	0.93
W4	All-bid sensitivity	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10	16.6	10.5	+3.4	0.76	0.96

Weekly and season multipliers

Observed bid divided by intrinsic suggestion; arithmetic, geometric, and median summaries are all shown.

SCOPE	OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	DEFINED/TOTAL	ARITHMETIC ×	GEOMETRIC ×	MEDIAN ×
Season	Canonical winner	Max VORP	36/70	1.899	0.000	1.840
Season	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	36/70	1.990	0.000	1.908
Season	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	36/70	1.119	0.000	1.016
Season	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	34/70	2.582	0.000	1.747
Season	Serious median	Max VORP	31/70	1.343	1.112	1.200
Season	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	31/70	1.393	1.154	1.200
Season	Serious median	Corrected Safe	31/70	0.756	0.632	0.606
Season	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	30/70	2.142	1.264	0.896
W2	Canonical winner	Max VORP	14/20	1.882	0.000	1.742
W2	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	14/20	1.892	0.000	1.742
W2	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	14/20	1.054	0.000	0.794
W2	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	13/20	2.880	0.000	1.414
W2	Serious median	Max VORP	11/20	1.658	1.264	1.400
W2	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	11/20	1.663	1.270	1.400
W2	Serious median	Corrected Safe	11/20	0.856	0.673	0.698
W2	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10/20	2.985	1.478	1.161
W3	Canonical winner	Max VORP	11/25	1.682	0.000	1.667
W3	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	11/25	1.859	0.000	1.808
W3	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	11/25	1.139	0.000	1.067
W3	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	11/25	2.708	0.000	1.764
W3	Serious median	Max VORP	10/25	0.923	0.856	0.822
W3	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	10/25	0.991	0.922	0.956
W3	Serious median	Corrected Safe	10/25	0.607	0.545	0.616
W3	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10/25	1.899	1.126	0.783
W4	Canonical winner	Max VORP	11/25	2.137	1.886	2.467
W4	Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	11/25	2.245	1.946	2.467
W4	Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	11/25	1.181	0.982	1.032
W4	Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10/25	2.058	1.771	1.814
W4	Serious median	Max VORP	10/25	1.417	1.256	1.210
W4	Serious median	Current-team VoRP	10/25	1.500	1.300	1.210
W4	Serious median	Corrected Safe	10/25	0.796	0.684	0.582

SCOPE	OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	DEFINED/TOTAL	ARITHMETIC ×	GEOMETRIC ×	MEDIAN ×
W4	Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	10/25	1.543	1.213	0.985

Prior-week-fitted held-out scale

Each prior eligible week's median multiplier is fit once, then applied to the next eligible week without refitting. Raw held-out R²* remains an unfitted prediction score.

OBSERVATION	STRATEGY	FIT→TEST	MULTIPLIER	N	MAE	BIAS	RAW R ² *	P
Canonical winner	Max VORP	W2→W3	1.742×	11	24.7	-9.6	0.69	0.91
Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	W2→W3	1.742×	11	26.3	-17.2	0.56	0.91
Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	W2→W3	0.794×	11	37.3	-29.1	0.27	0.91
Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	W2→W3	1.414×	11	28.9	-14.2	0.64	0.87
Canonical winner	Max VORP	W3→W4	1.667×	11	32.5	-24.5	0.69	0.90
Canonical winner	Current-team VoRP	W3→W4	1.808×	11	33.4	-23.7	0.62	0.89
Canonical winner	Corrected Safe	W3→W4	1.067×	11	37.7	-22.0	0.46	0.93
Canonical winner	Corrected Weeks as Starter	W3→W4	1.764×	10	24.5	-11.4	0.80	0.88
Serious median	Max VORP	W2→W3	1.400×	10	22.7	+22.2	-1.20	0.91
Serious median	Current-team VoRP	W2→W3	1.400×	10	15.9	+15.5	-0.02	0.91
Serious median	Corrected Safe	W2→W3	0.698×	10	10.4	+8.0	0.51	0.91
Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	W2→W3	1.161×	10	26.6	+19.4	-1.73	0.88
Serious median	Max VORP	W3→W4	0.822×	10	22.2	-21.1	0.49	0.75
Serious median	Current-team VoRP	W3→W4	0.956×	10	20.7	-18.5	0.48	0.72
Serious median	Corrected Safe	W3→W4	0.616×	10	21.7	-14.6	0.38	0.78
Serious median	Corrected Weeks as Starter	W3→W4	0.783×	10	18.2	-17.3	0.54	0.77

Compact with-vs-without sensitivity

private GET-only catalog match plus exact position/total fingerprints in both reconstructed snapshots map uniquely to one canonical completed W3 win at \$234; marker only, with no private identity stored.

VIEW	CLUSTERS	CLOSEST	MAX VORP MAE	CURRENT-TEAM VORP MAE	CORRECTED SAFE MAE	CORRECTED WEEKS AS STARTER MAE
Owner-directed exclusion	41	Current-team VoRP	\$14.0	\$13.8	\$22.9	\$17.3
Raw evidence retained	42	Current-team VoRP	\$14.0	\$13.7	\$22.2	\$17.4

Interpretation boundary

The owner-directed marker is excluded only from this labeled analysis; raw canonical evidence remains in the sensitivity row. Serious means bid > \$5, failed claims must be legitimate same-target competitors, and FAAB-limited observations are marked censored. This supports a strategy-shape × market-scale hypothesis, not individual manager-style conclusions from 3 reconstructed weeks.

Behavioral-question audit appendix

Privacy-safe exact manual app-Week-5 aggregates are supplemented only where explicitly labeled by the W2–W4 reconstructed replay. These provenance classes are not interchangeable.

QUESTION	AVAILABLE EVIDENCE / N	CURRENT ANSWER
Price bands: median / upper quartile / top credible / top all	Exact manual W5 audit: 11 target rows. Top-credible MAE \$36.36, median AE \$25, signed bias +\$16.91, Spearman 0.712; top-all MAE \$47.27, median AE \$48, signed bias +\$40.91, Spearman 0.796.	The ordering signal was useful, but levels were too high overall and errors differed materially by target tier. Privacy-safe median and upper-quartile prediction bands were not retained as a separate deterministic slice, so premium-versus-mid/lower band calibration remains prospective rather than inferred from 11 auctions.
Likely / Possible / Unlikely as claim probabilities and threshold outcomes	Full exact W5 incidence audit: Likely 31/65 (47.7%), Possible 34/108 (31.5%), Unlikely 15/69 (21.7%). Restricted cross-check: 50 manager predictions, 5 canonical claims, 4 observed players, 11 teams.	The labels were directionally ordered for any canonical claim, but separation was weak and the restricted cross-check is tiny. Positive-claim, ≥Max VORP, ≥Safe, ≥serious-median, and ≥observed-minimum bands are not credibly estimable from this one auction; those outcomes remain preregistered prospective tests.
Prior wins, same-position wins, remaining FAAB, and prior-week top bidders	Longitudinal reconstructed replay contains 240 serious bids and 72 winners, but the exact W5 behavioral slice does not contain a clean prior-only panel for these covariates.	No causal or manager-style claim is supported. Effects for prior wins ≥10%/≥20% starting FAAB, prior same-position wins, budget level, and prior-week top-bidder participation/heavy spend remain prospective; budget capacity must be separated from willingness.
Aggressive versus wins and observed minimum proxies	Exact W5, n=11: Aggressive MAE \$26.27 versus winners (bias –\$12.27; 5/11 at or above the winner) and MAE \$18.09 versus observed minimum proxies (bias +\$10.27; 10/11 at or above the proxy).	Aggressive behaved more like a rough threshold than a winning-price forecast, but it was not a reliable minimum: it still missed one observed proxy and commonly exceeded the proxy. Keep it out of the four-method owner multiplier tables because it is derived from Safe.
Aggressive versus 1.5× Max VORP and a cautious tier-aware candidate	Exact W5, n=11: simple 1.5× Max VORP had winner MAE \$36.45 and minimum-proxy MAE \$27.18, worse than Aggressive at \$26.27 / \$18.09. Longitudinal winner replay favors Aggressive in-sample, but no prior-only held-out comparison validates a replacement curve.	The manual audit rejects simple 1.5× Max VORP as an improvement. A cautious tier-aware candidate is only a hypothesis until preregistered exact pre-waiver and held-out evidence exists; no production formula change is warranted.
Prediction distribution and right-tail shape	Only 11 exact W5 target rows; top-all estimates were more upward biased than top-credible estimates.	The sample is compatible with a heavy right tail, but is far too small to identify an exponential or other parametric distribution. Report empirical quantiles only when a larger exact sample exists.
Weekly free-agent rank 1/2/3/later prices	The committed privacy-safe fixture does not retain an exact auction-time free-agent rank with quality, position, injury, active-team, and liquidity controls.	Starting-FAAB shares and Max-VORP/Aggressive multiples by free-agent rank are not credibly estimable here. Preserve this as a descriptive prospective analysis with the named controls.
Claims per manager/auction, alternatives, duplicates, and spend	Exact W5: 107 raw claims, 84 unique manager/player pairs, and 23 additional same-manager alternatives. The owner-team slice had 8 raw and 7 canonical claims.	One auction cannot establish a manager’s “usual claims per auction,” clean claim-count quantiles, or a stable relation to wins/spend. Alternatives and contingency paths must stay separate from canonical claims.
Projected positional need	No privacy-safe, time-aligned roster-need feature with adequate controls is present in the exact behavioral slice or reconstructed replay.	Need-as-predictor is unsupported. Future work must distinguish modeled roster need from observed intent and control for player quality, position, injury, active teams, liquidity, and remaining FAAB.
Do prior-week top bidders bid less next week?	The available exact manual audit is one auction; the reconstructed replay is not a clean prior-only manager panel for this question.	Not estimable. Test raw dollars and starting-/remaining-FAAB-normalized bids prospectively across additional exact auctions.

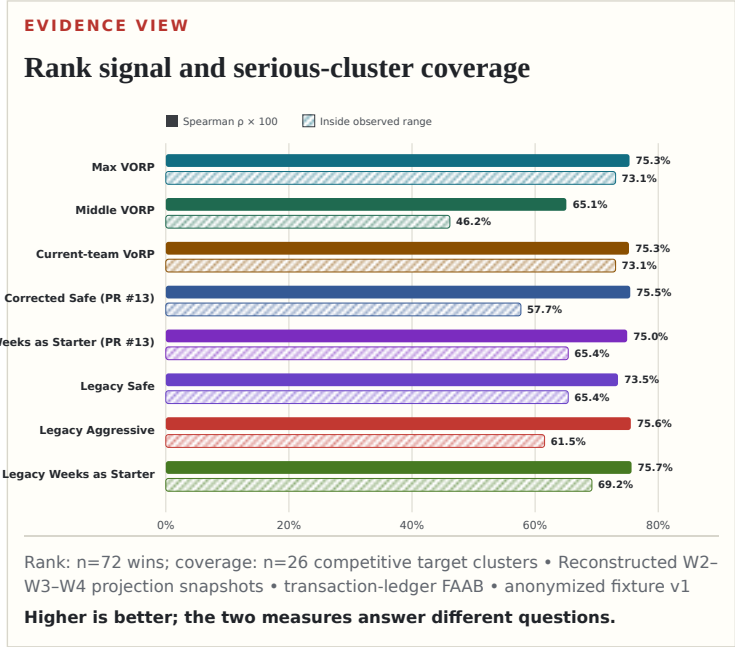
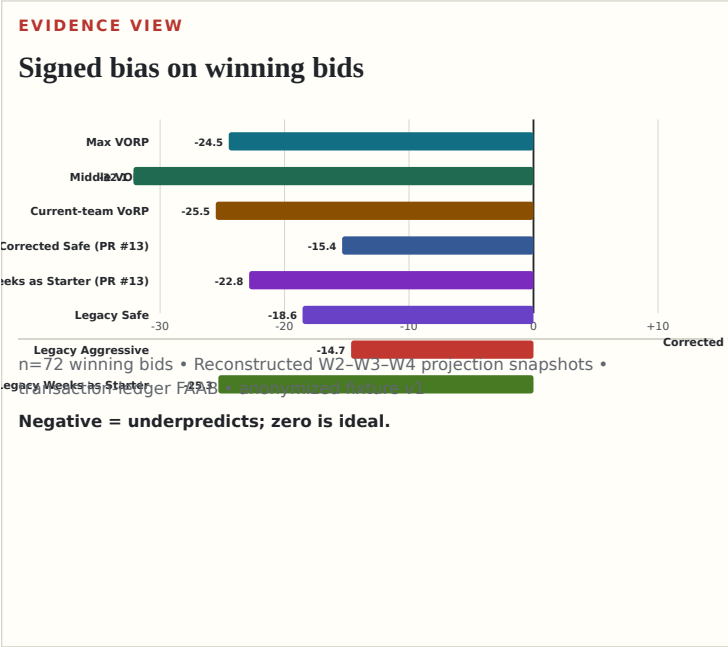
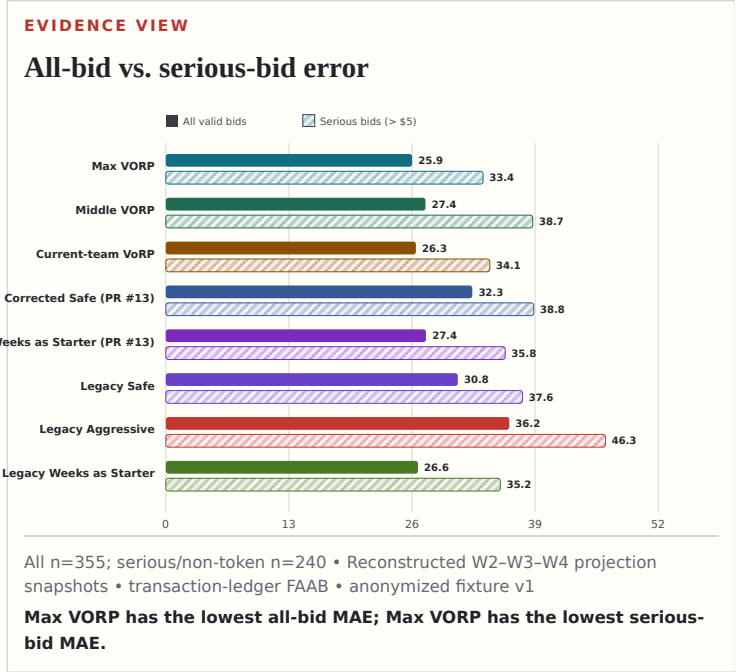
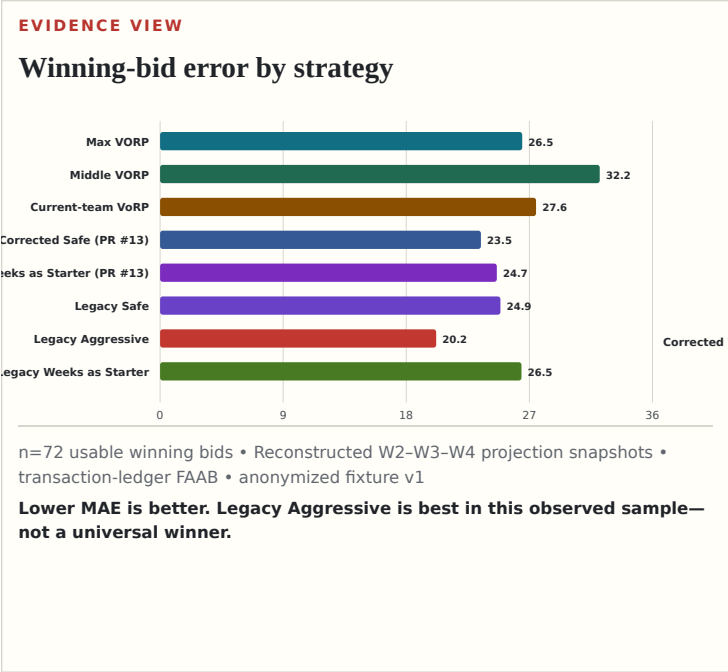
Owner-team appendix (privacy-safe)

- **Scope:** Exact W5 owner-team slice: 8 raw claims, 7 canonical claims; behavioral cross-check includes 5 canonical claims across 4 observed players.
- **Acquisition / spend / remaining:** One acquisition for \$187 from \$499 pre-waiver FAAB, leaving \$312. Its observed minimum proxy was \$159 and top-credible prediction was \$244, so the clearing price landed inside that wide audit band.
- **Failed contingencies and process quality:** Tiered coverage produced one intended premium acquisition and preserved substantial FAAB, but three later claims were explicitly rejected as roster-full. Contingency/roster-capacity sequencing was therefore imperfect; hidden drop paths are not inferred and failed claims are not treated as clearing competition. This is a process-quality observation, not evidence that the acquisition will produce a good future outcome.
- **Lineup / risk:** Strength: one premium skill-position addition without exhausting budget. Optimized lineup, injury risk, and remaining positional holes are not supported by the privacy-safe post-waiver evidence and are intentionally not fabricated.

Limitation. Three reconstructed auctions plus one exact manual audit do not support stable manager-style, positional-need, longitudinal behavioral, or parametric right-tail claims. Unsupported questions remain prospective hypotheses.

Price fit depends on the question.

Winning-bid error asks who best estimates the clearing price. All-bid error also includes failed claims and token bids. Lower MAE is better; bias shows direction.



Winning-bid scorecard n=72; subset=usable winning bids • Reconstructed W2-W3-W4 projection snapshots • transaction-ledger FAAB • anonymized fixture v1									
STRATEGY	N	MAE ↓	95% BOOTSTRAP MAE CI	MEDIAN AE ↓	BIAS	SPEARMAN P ↑	WITHIN TOLERANCE ↑	ACTUAL RANGE	PREDICTED RANGE
● Max VORP	72	26.5	16.3–38.4	6.0	-24.5	0.75	45.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$102
● Middle VORP	72	32.2	20.9–45.1	10.0	-32.1	0.65	43.1%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$85
● Current-team VoRP	72	27.6	16.8–39.9	6.0	-25.5	0.75	45.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$80
● Corrected Safe (PR #13)	72	23.5	14.3–34.5	6.0	-15.4	0.75	50.0%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Corrected Weeks as Starter (PR #13)	72	24.7	14.9–36.3	5.0	-22.8	0.75	52.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Legacy Safe	72	24.9	15.1–36.1	6.0	-18.6	0.73	48.6%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Legacy Aggressive	72	20.2	12.4–29.8	6.0	-14.7	0.76	52.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$186
● Legacy Weeks as Starter	72	26.5	16.3–38.0	5.5	-25.3	0.76	50.0%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106

All and serious scorecard — all bids n=355; subset=all formula-usable bids • Reconstructed W2-W3-W4 projection snapshots • transaction-ledger FAAB • anonymized fixture v1									
STRATEGY	N	MAE ↓	95% BOOTSTRAP MAE CI	MEDIAN AE ↓	BIAS	SPEARMAN P ↑	WITHIN TOLERANCE ↑	ACTUAL RANGE	PREDICTED RANGE
● Max VORP	355	25.9	17.7–33.7	15.0	-6.2	0.78	31.3%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$102
● Middle VORP	355	27.4	17.7–36.4	14.0	-19.6	0.76	38.0%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$85
● Current-team VoRP	355	26.3	17.2–35.9	15.0	-9.5	0.78	31.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$80
● Corrected Safe (PR #13)	355	32.3	24.7–38.7	25.0	+10.2	0.77	28.5%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Corrected Weeks as Starter (PR #13)	355	27.4	18.8–34.9	16.0	-0.6	0.77	35.2%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Legacy Safe	355	30.8	23.2–37.4	23.0	+4.7	0.74	29.0%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106
● Legacy Aggressive	355	36.2	25.3–45.5	19.0	+22.2	0.77	33.8%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$186
● Legacy Weeks as Starter	355	26.6	17.9–34.2	14.0	-5.4	0.77	34.4%	\$0–\$300	\$0–\$106

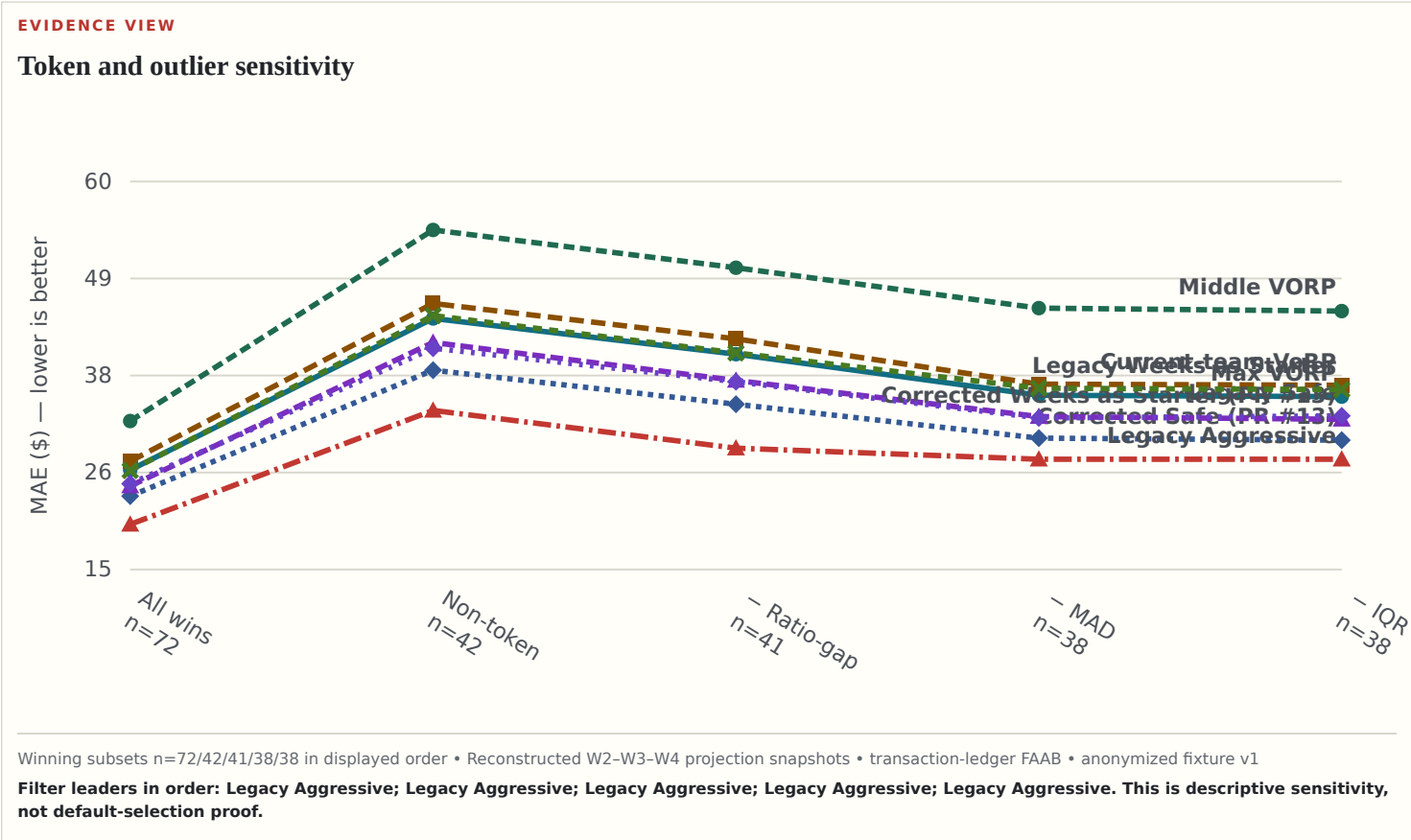
All and serious scorecard — serious bids

n=240; subset=non-token bids > \$5 • Reconstructed W2-W3-W4 projection snapshots • transaction-ledger FAAB • anonymized fixture v1

STRATEGY	N	MAE ↓	95% BOOTSTRAP MAE CI	MEDIAN AE ↓	BIAS	SPEARMAN P ↑	WITHIN TOLERANCE ↑	ACTUAL RANGE	PREDICTED RANGE
● Max VORP	240	33.4	23.3–42.5	21.0	-13.6	0.65	18.3%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$102
● Middle VORP	240	38.7	27.1–48.8	25.5	-29.8	0.65	11.7%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$85
● Current-team VoRP	240	34.1	22.4–45.3	20.0	-18.5	0.65	19.2%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$80
● Corrected Safe (PR #13)	240	38.8	31.3–46.1	33.5	+6.5	0.64	20.0%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$106
● Corrected Weeks as Starter (PR #13)	240	35.8	26.3–43.9	24.5	-5.3	0.64	21.3%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$106
● Legacy Safe	240	37.6	29.7–45.1	30.0	-0.5	0.60	18.8%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$106
● Legacy Aggressive	240	46.3	35.2–56.7	34.5	+26.1	0.63	20.0%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$186
● Legacy Weeks as Starter	240	35.2	25.8–43.7	23.0	-11.6	0.63	20.0%	\$6-\$300	\$0-\$106

Sensitivity stays explicit across filters.

These filters were declared before inspecting winners and applied independently. They are sensitivity checks, not permission to delete inconvenient evidence.

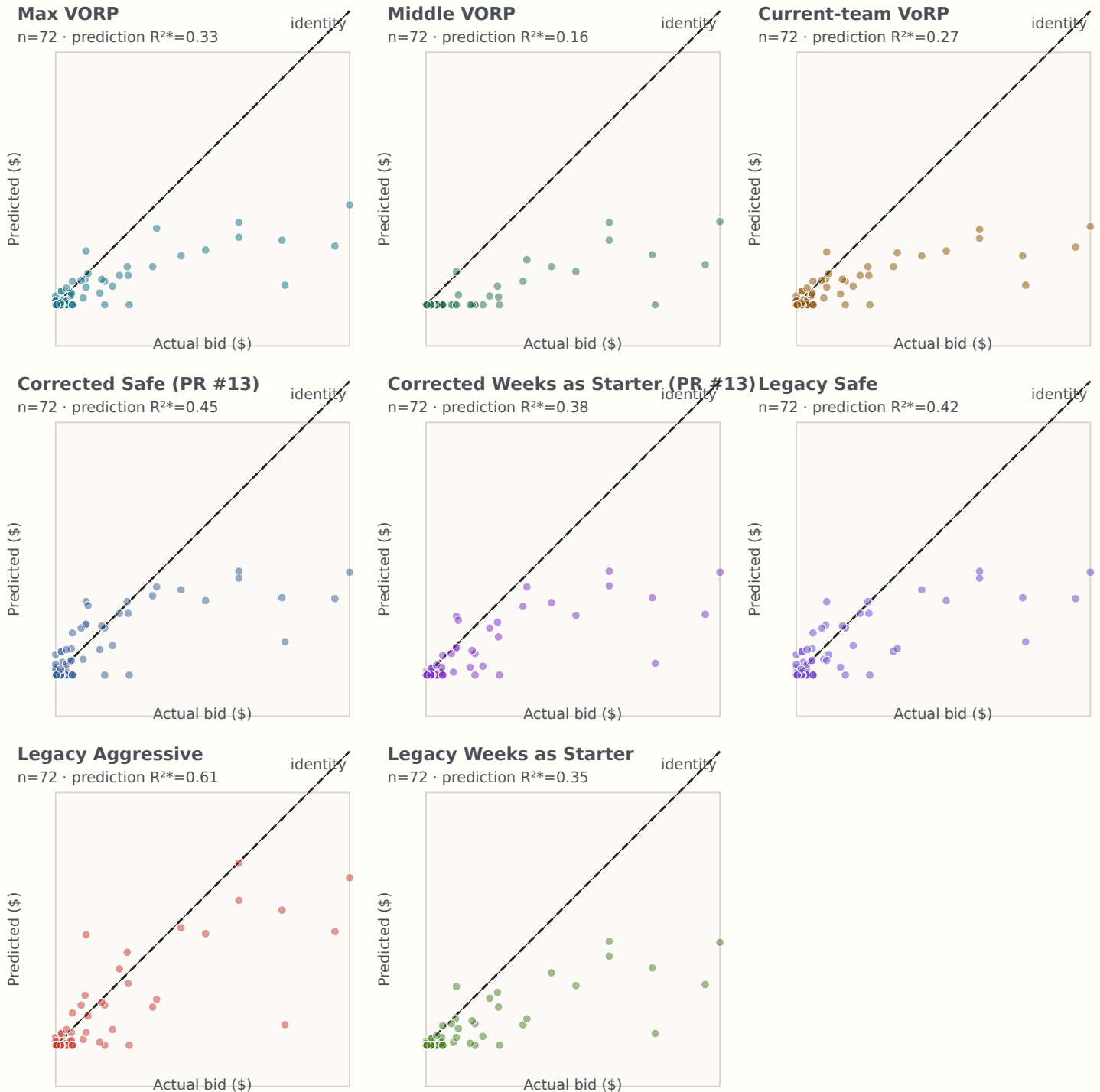


Identity lines expose the misses.

Each dot is an anonymized winning target. A perfect forecast lies on the dashed diagonal; below it underpredicts. Extreme observed bids stretch beyond every intrinsic strategy; Aggressive reaches higher than the others, but still underpredicts the largest win.

EVIDENCE VIEW

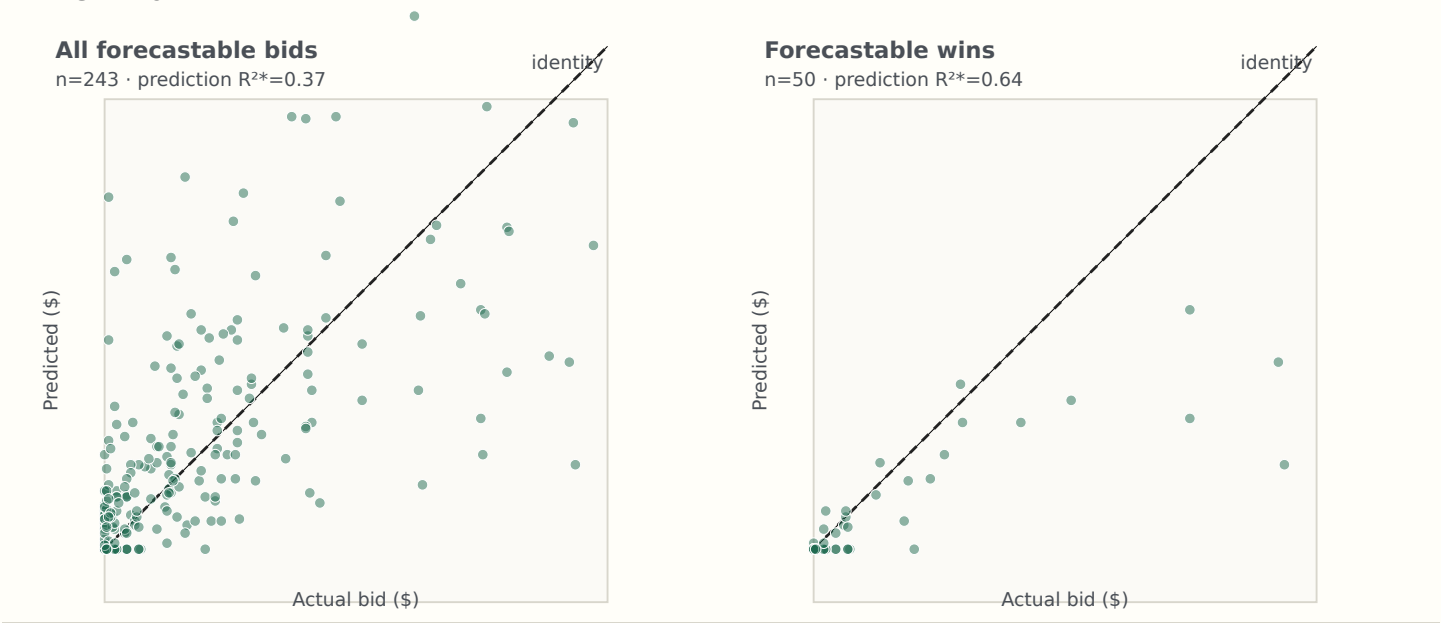
Actual vs. predicted: where errors happen



n=72 winning bids per strategy • reconstructed W2-W3-W4 • anonymized targets

* Prediction R^2 is scored against the identity line with no regression refit. It is not fitted-regression R^2 and may be negative.

Manager-adjusted walk-forward forecasts



n=243 all forecastable / n=50 wins • strict prior-batch subset • Reconstructed W2-W3-W4 projection snapshots • transaction-ledger FAAB • anonymized fixture v1
Separate subset: 106 of 239 usable bids lacked sufficient prior-only manager evidence.

Manager-adjusted subset

Strict prior-batch walk-forward • Reconstructed W2-W3-W4 projection snapshots • transaction-ledger FAAB • anonymized fixture v1 • smaller, non-comparable subset

FORECAST SUBSET	N	MAE	MEDIAN AE	BIAS	SPEARMAN P	PREDICTION R^{2*}	WITHIN TOLERANCE
All forecastable bids	243	28.8	16.0	+6.1	0.75	0.37	37.4%
Forecastable wins	50	18.9	5.0	-16.5	0.80	0.64	58.0%

Measures, assumptions, and guardrails.

All formulas are evaluated on dollars unless marked normalized. Predictions are intrinsic strategy values; manager forecasts are capped at reconstructed pre-bid FAAB.

MAE MAE = (1/n) Σ predicted – actual Average dollar miss. Easy to interpret; extreme bids still matter.	Median absolute error Median AE = median(predicted – actual) The typical dollar miss; less sensitive to a small number of extremes.	Signed bias Bias = (1/n) Σ (predicted – actual) Negative means systematic underprediction; positive means overprediction.
Spearman rank correlation ρ = Pearson correlation(rank(actual), rank(predicted)) Tests whether expensive targets rank above cheap ones. Ties receive average ranks.	Prediction R² (unfitted) R² = 1 – SSE / SST This is the standard predictive score against the observed-mean baseline, but not fitted-regression R². Strategy dollars remain fixed on the identity line. A negative value means they are worse than predicting the observed mean; it does not mean negative correlation.	Normalized FAAB error mean(predicted/FAAB – actual/FAAB) Reported against original \$500 and reconstructed pre-bid manager FAAB. It compares budget share, not willingness.
Cluster-bootstrap interval 2,000 resamples of player × processing-batch clusters Fixed seed 20260927; percentile 2.5%–97.5%. Keeps correlated win/loss claims together. It does not repair snapshot-history error.	Coverage predicted ∈ [lowest serious loss, winning bid] Computed on 26 competitive player/batch clusters. It asks whether a strategy falls inside observed serious bidding range.	Outlier rules ratio ≥ 2× + \$50 gap; MAD > median + 3×1.4826×MAD; IQR > Q3 + 1.5×IQR MAD/IQR also require a \$25 gap; minimum cluster sizes are 3 and 4. Flags are independent and never silently deleted.
Within tolerance predicted – actual ≤ max(\$5, 20% of actual) A practical accuracy band shown alongside continuous error measures.		

Provenance boundary

All 355 formula-usable events use same-week reconstructed W2/W3/W4 projection snapshots and transaction-ledger FAAB reconstruction. Read-only sources are Supabase REST tables `projection_snapshot_runs/projection_snapshot_values` and Sleeper GET endpoints `/v1/league/[private]`, `/v1/players/nfl`, and `/v1/league/[private]/transactions/{week}`. Reconstructed means captured after the canonical cutoff; it is not proof of what managers saw. Earlier-week fallbacks are excluded rather than substituted. No identities, project or league identifier, player names/IDs, manager names/IDs, raw payload, or credentials appear in this artifact. Regenerate deterministically with `npm run analyze:bidding:presentation`.